PHUMELELA MDINGI

Junior Software Developer | Python & Django
Cape Town, South Africa
GitHub: github.com/PhumelelaM7 | LinkedIn | HyperionDev Portfolio

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Software Engineering Bootcamp graduate (HyperionDev, in partnership with Stellenbosch University) building full-stack web applications in Python and Django, with REST APIs, JWT authentication, SQL databases and automated tests. Brings seven-plus years of client-facing problem solving and is ready to contribute to a junior developer role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python (object-oriented programming), SQL, HTML, CSS
Frameworks & APIs: Django, Django REST Framework, REST API design, JWT authentication
Databases: MySQL / MariaDB, relational schema design and modelling
DevOps & Tooling: Docker, Docker Compose, Git, GitHub
Quality & Practice: Automated testing (Django test framework), Sphinx documentation, role-based access control (RBAC)
Soft skills: Structured problem-solving and debugging · clear written and verbal communication · cross-team collaboration · time management (SLA/KPI targets) · attention to detail · adaptability · receptive to feedback

PROJECTS

MostOdd News: Django Capstone Project **Feb 2026 – Aug 2026**
Full-stack news publishing platform with role-based access | Completed (HyperionDev capstone)
Repository: github.com/PhumelelaM7/MostOdd-News **| Tech:** Python, Django, Django REST Framework, JWT, MariaDB, Docker, Docker Compose, Sphinx, Git

- Built a publishing platform with three user roles (Reader, Journalist, Editor), with permissions enforced through RBAC so each role only sees and does what it is allowed to
- Designed and implemented a REST API with Django REST Framework, secured with JWT token-based authentication
- Modelled the MariaDB schema and built an article approval workflow that sends automated email notifications to subscribers
- Wrote automated API tests with the Django test framework to verify endpoints and permissions; containerised the application with Docker and Docker Compose and documented it with Sphinx
- Improved the project after reviewer feedback by adding inline subscription actions and editor shortcuts

Status Window: Gamified Daily Quest & Goal Planner **2026 – Present**
Multi-user Django web app (installable PWA) for planning goals and daily schedules | Working application; further features in development
Repository: github.com/PhumelelaM7/Status-Window **| Tech:** Python, Django, MariaDB, HTML, CSS, Git

- Rewrote an earlier Kivy prototype as a Django application, keeping scheduling logic separate from views and committing one feature at a time with Git
- Built multi-user authentication with sign-up, login and per-user profiles; every view is login-protected and filtered by user, with data isolation verified by running two accounts side by side
- Built relational models for goals, quests and daily schedules, with a scheduling engine for timelines, streaks, progress, rescheduling and overdue quests, plus a distraction-free focus mode with a countdown timer
- Migrated the database from SQLite to MariaDB and debugged stale static files, time-zone errors and template issues; in development: quest categories, a user profile page, and completed-goals and skills tracking

SoSo The Barber: Barber Shop Booking & Management App **2026 – Present**
Django web app and REST API for a two-location barber shop | In development (not yet launched)
Repository: github.com/PhumelelaM7/SoSo_The_Barber **| Tech:** Python, Django, Django REST Framework, MySQL / MariaDB

- Planned booking and management platform for a barber shop in Cape Town and Langa, with separate owner, barber and customer roles and a Django REST API backend to serve a future mobile app
- Planned features: owner revenue (daily, weekly, per barber) and account administration; barber appointments and earnings by shop; customer haircut selection, payment, emailed invoices and loyalty points

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Associate – WNS **Aug 2026 – Present**

- Customer Service Representative at an insurance company, providing front-line support to policyholders on billing, coverage changes, vehicle updates, address changes and general policy enquiries

Customer Service Advisor – EXL Service, Call Centre, Cape Town **Oct 2025 – Jan 2026**

- Met strict SLA and quality targets in a fast-paced environment; learned new systems quickly and kept accurate CRM records with a full audit trail

Customer Service Advisor – Capita SA, Mobile Network Support **Nov 2024 – Sep 2025**

- Diagnosed account, billing and technical issues step by step, achieving consistent first-contact resolution, and worked with other teams to resolve complex escalations

Customer Service Advisor – Merchants SA, Walmart E-commerce Campaign **Apr 2023 – Jun 2024**

- Worked with logistics and fulfilment teams to trace and resolve escalated order and account issues

Earlier roles

- Admin Clerk / Receptionist – Myganet Training and Trade Centre: kept organised digital and physical records and processed documentation accurately (Jan 2022 – Mar 2023)
- Customer Service Advisor – Webhelp SA, E-commerce & Delivery Support: supported international clients, consistently meeting resolution-rate and satisfaction KPIs (Apr 2018 – Sep 2021)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Software Engineering Bootcamp – HyperionDev, in partnership with Stellenbosch University Feb 2026 – Aug 2026

N3 Certificate: Electrical Engineering (Heavy Current) – Northlink College, Cape Town 2016

National Senior Certificate (Matric) – Randallstown High School 2011